UNIVERSITY OF ABUJA

Department of Physics · Postgraduate Journey Portal

Supervisor User Guide

Supervising your postgraduate students in the portal

This guide shows supervisors how to monitor their students, run supervision meetings, give feedback, endorse submissions, record progress reviews and raise concerns, using the My Students dashboard.

Document	Details
Version	November 2026 (reflects the portal after the supervision, journey-tracker and examiner-workload updates)
Audience	Academic staff acting as Main Supervisor or Co-Supervisor (role: Staff)
Portal address	The web-app link sent to you by the PG Coordinator
Help	Help & FAQ page inside the portal, or an Inquiry to the PG Coordinator

In this guide

- Your role in the journey
- Signing in, passwords and notifications
- The My Students dashboard
- Supervision meetings
- Action items, check-ins and reviews
- Submissions and feedback
- Messages and assignments
- Troubleshooting and quick reference

1. Your role in the journey

What supervisors do

As Main or Co-Supervisor you guide the student through all 16 stages. The portal asks for your action at specific points and gives you tools to stay in touch with each student.

Stage	Your involvement
4 Title Approval	Both supervisors approve the proposed thesis title.
5 Proposal Submission	Review the proposal and endorse where the checklist requires it.
6 Defence Readiness	Approve the readiness request (or sign the Proposal Defence Form).
8 Progress Report Intent	Approve the request to present the progress report.
11 Final Examination Intent	Approve the request for the final examination.
12 Thesis Submission	Endorse the thesis before the Inspector reviews it.
15 Final Compliance	Endorse the final corrected copy.

Access You see only students for whom you are Main or Co-Supervisor.

Stage reference

#	Stage	What happens	Who acts
1	Admission	Registration and university orientation completed.	Student, PG Coordinator
2	Lecture Attendance	Required lectures (MSc students only).	Student
3	Supervisor Allocation	Main and Co-Supervisor assigned.	PG Coordinator / HoD
4	Title Approval	Thesis title submitted and approved by both supervisors.	Student, supervisors
5	Proposal Submission	Research Proposal uploaded, format-checked and approved.	Student, Inspector, Coordinator
6	Defence Readiness	Signed Proposal Defence Form uploaded, or readiness approved in the system.	Student, supervisors, Coordinator
7	Proposal Defence ◆	Defence at the monthly seminar; outcome recorded. **Gate.**	Coordinator
8	Progress Report Intent	Approval to present the progress report.	Supervisors, Coordinator
9	Internal Examiner Assignment	An Internal Examiner from another department is appointed.	Coordinator / HoD

#	Stage	What happens	Who acts
10	Progress Presentation ◆	Presentation (PPTX) checked and approved. **Gate.**	Student, Coordinator, Inspector
11	Final Examination Intent	Approval for the final examination.	Supervisors, Coordinator
12	Thesis Submission ◆	Thesis uploaded; format and similarity checks; approval. **Gate.**	Student, Inspector, Coordinator
13	External Examiner Assignment ◆	An External Examiner from another university is appointed. **Gate.**	Coordinator / HoD
14	Examiners' Comments	Examiner comments, comment-by-comment response and final corrections.	Student
15	Final Compliance ◆	Supervisors endorse; Inspector and Coordinator approve the final copy. **Gate.**	Supervisors, Inspector, Coordinator
16	Signed Copies and Completion	Signed copies submitted to the PG Coordinator; journey complete.	Student, Coordinator

2. Signing in, passwords and notifications

Sign in for the first time

1. Open the portal link and choose **Login**.
2. Enter your **registration number** (students) or **staff ID** (for example ACA1234), then the one-time password sent to you by email or given by the PG Coordinator.
3. You are asked to choose a new password. It must be 8–128 characters, contain at least one letter and one number, and must not be your registration number or a common password.

> **Good to know** After 5 wrong attempts the account is locked for 15 minutes. Your session ends automatically after about 6 hours; just sign in again.

Forgot your password

1. On the sign-in page choose **Forgot password?** enter your registration number or staff ID and press **Email me a code**.
2. A 6-digit code is sent to the email address on your account. It expires after 30 minutes.
3. Enter the code and your new password. You can request a code up to 3 times per hour. If no email arrives, check your spam folder or contact the PG Coordinator.

Notifications and email settings

- The **bell** (top right) shows unread updates. Opening it marks them as read.
- Red numbers on menu tabs show how many items are waiting for you.

- On **Help & FAQ**, set Email notifications to Instant, Daily digest or Off (bell only). Account and security emails are always sent.
- Use the moon icon to switch between light and dark theme, **Change password** to update your password, and **Sign out** when you finish, especially on a shared computer.
- Emails come from a no-reply address. Do not reply to them; use Messages or Inquiries in the portal instead.

Change your email address

1. Open **Help & FAQ** and find the **My account** card.
2. Type the new address and press **Send confirmation code**. The 6-digit code goes to the NEW address, so the change only happens if you can open it.
3. Enter the code (valid for 30 minutes) and press **Confirm new email**.

> **Note** An address that another account already uses is refused. You can request a code up to 3 times per hour.

3. The My Students dashboard

Summary tiles

The top of **My Students** shows: students supervised, at risk / stalled, awaiting my endorsement (with overdue count), meetings this month and open action items (with overdue count).

Needs attention

This list collects what needs you now, each with quick buttons:

- Students stalled for over 90 days, or with no logged meeting for more than 30 days — **Schedule meeting** or **Message**.
- Students who reported their month as **Slow** or **Blocked** — **Reply** or **Schedule meeting**.
- Submissions that were Rejected or sent back with Changes Requested — **Feedback**.
- Submissions awaiting your endorsement that are due soon or overdue — **Endorse** or **Feedback**.
- Approval requests (title, readiness, progress, final examination) waiting for you.
- Your own action items that are overdue — **Mark done**.

The student list

Use the search box and the filters (stage, programme, status) and the sort menu (name, days at stage, longest since contact, needs attention first). Each row shows:

- **Status** with a coloured dot: green (on track), amber (needs a check-in), red (at risk), grey (completed). Red means stalled, a review marked *At risk* or a *Blocked* check-in. Amber means more than 30 days without a logged meeting, a *Slow* check-in, a *Concern* review or overdue actions.

- **Stage** and how many days the student has been at it, last meeting date, the latest check-in and review, and open action items.
- Your role (Main or Co-Supervisor), the other supervisor, and contact details.

Row buttons

Button	What it does
Schedule	Schedule a meeting with a calendar invitation.
Log meeting	Record a meeting that already took place.
Messages	Open the message thread with the student.
Add action	Create an action item for the student or yourself.
Review	Record a structured progress review.
Handover	See the full history summary (useful for a new supervisor).
Timeline	See the student's journey timeline.
Raise concern	Send a confidential concern to the PG Coordinator.

Capacity and calendar

- **My capacity** shows your number of students against the recommended maximum (default 8), by programme and stage. It turns amber at the limit and red above it.
- **My upcoming calendar** lists your scheduled meetings, deadlines, seminars and your own action due dates. Press **Download .ics** to add them to your calendar.

4. Supervision meetings

Schedule a meeting

1. Press **Schedule** beside the student.
2. Pick one of the **Suggested slots** (next four weekdays at 10:00 and 14:00) or choose the date and time yourself; add the venue and an optional agenda.
3. Press **Schedule**. The student, you and the other supervisor receive an email with a calendar file.

After the meeting

1. Under **Supervision Meetings** (bottom of the page) press **Record notes**. Enter the notes and action points.
2. The student is asked to acknowledge them; you can see who has.
3. Use **Add action** to turn agreed points into tracked action items with a due date.

> **Students can contribute** Students may add their own agenda points to a scheduled meeting. These appear under the meeting as "Student's agenda", and you are notified when they add them.

Other options

- **Cancel** a meeting that will not take place; the student is notified.
- **Log meeting** records a meeting that has already happened.
- When the other supervisor logs a meeting, press **Mark seen** so both supervisors know it has been read. The **Seen by** names appear on the meeting.

5. Action items, check-ins and reviews

Action items

1. Press **Add action** beside the student.
2. Write the action, choose who should do it (the student or you) and an optional due date.
3. The student is notified when the action is theirs. Anyone can press **Mark done** on their own items; you can also close a student's item.

Reminders Overdue items trigger a reminder to the owner every few days. They also appear in your Needs attention list.

Monthly student check-ins

Students report **On track**, **Slow** or **Blocked** each month with a note. You are notified of Slow or Blocked reports, and the latest check-in shows in the student row.

Progress reviews

1. Press **Review** beside the student.
2. Enter the period (for example 2025/2026 first semester), choose a progress rating (Excellent, Good, Satisfactory, Unsatisfactory) and a recommendation (Continue, Concern, At risk).
3. Add comments (required for Concern or At risk) and press **Save review**.

Visibility The student and the PG Coordinator can see the review. If you choose Concern or At risk, the PG Coordinator is alerted.

Raise a confidential concern

1. Press **Raise concern** beside the student.
2. Choose a category (not responding, welfare, academic progress, funding, supervisor relationship, other) and describe the concern.
3. Press **Send to coordinator**.

Confidential Concerns go only to the PG Coordinator and HoD. The student cannot see them.

Handover for a new supervisor

When you are assigned to a student who had a previous supervisor, press **Handover**. It shows the student's stage and title, open actions, reviews, check-ins, recent meetings and submission notes, so no history is lost.

6. Submissions and feedback

Read, comment on and endorse

1. **Submissions from My Students** lists documents with status, files and inspector comments.
2. Press **Read / Edit** to open files in the portal. Word files can be edited in Google Docs.
3. Press **Feedback** to open the written thread for that document; comments notify the student.
4. Press **Add Note** to record a supervisory note the student can see.
5. Press **Endorse** when satisfied. Several inspector checklists require *Supervisor endorsement attached*, so endorse before the inspector reviews.

Reply deadline

Submissions awaiting your endorsement show **reply due in N days** (default 7) or **N days overdue**. The PG Coordinator can see feedback that has waited too long. You also receive a reminder email every 3 days until you endorse.

Approval requests

Requests for title approval, defence readiness, progress presentation and final examination appear on your dashboard. Open the card and **Approve** or **Return** with a reason. The PG Coordinator then acts on those that need it.

7. Messages and assignments

Message students

1. Press **Messages** beside a student, type, optionally attach a file (under 5 MB) and **Send**.
2. To write to one or all of your students, use the **Send Message** form and choose *One of my assigned students* or *All my assigned students*.

- **Insert saved text** adds a ready-made or your own text; **Save this text** keeps one you reuse.

When you are assigned or removed

You receive a notification and an email whenever the PG Coordinator assigns you to, or removes you from, a student, with the student's details and the other supervisor. Your Drive access to the student's files is updated automatically.

8. Troubleshooting and quick reference

Common questions

Question	Answer
A student is missing from My Students.	You are not assigned to them. Ask the PG Coordinator to check the assignment.
I cannot endorse a submission.	It may already be endorsed, or its status is not Submitted / Under Review.
Why is a student red?	Stalled 90+ days, a review marked At risk, or a Blocked check-in. Open the row to see which.
Can the student see my concern?	No. Concerns are confidential to the PG Coordinator and HoD.
I am at capacity.	The limit is a recommendation (default 8). The PG Coordinator can change it in the Config tab (SUPERVISOR_MAX_STUDENTS).

Quick reference

I want to…	Go to…
See who needs attention	My Students → Needs attention
Schedule a meeting	Row button: Schedule
Record a review	Row button: Review
Endorse a document	Submissions from My Students → Endorse
Flag a worry confidentially	Row button: Raise concern
Brief a new supervisor	Row button: Handover